MODULE 8

A New Home

"There could be no place in the world to which he belonged so completely. That was why he'd always dreamed of leaving, and why he'd always been so afraid to go."

— DANIEL ALARCÓN

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How do people adapt to new experiences and make a new place home?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**A Movie in My Pillow**	· Jorge Argueta (illus. Elizabeth Gómez)	POETRY
2	**From Scratch**	· Susie Castellano (illus. Yelena Bryksenkova)	REALISTIC FICTION
3	**Elisa's Diary**	· Doris Luisa Oronoz (illus. Byron Gin)	REALISTIC FICTION
4	**Inside Out and Back Again**	· Thanhha Lai (illus. Lisa Fields)	POETRY

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A · Vocabulary (28) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 6

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 10

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 13

NAME _____ DATE _____

Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 8 · A New Home · Grade 5 · 28 Items

CCSS L.5.4 · L.5.5 · L.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Q1 L.5.5 TRAP

nomadic

A **nomadic** person — /div>

- ◯ **A.** always lives in the very same house.
- ◯ **B.** works only at night.
- ◯ **C.** moves frequently and might not have a permanent home.
- ◯ **D.** never travels anywhere at all.

Q2 L.5.5 TRAP

temporary

Something that is **temporary** — /div>

- A. lasts for only a limited time.
- B. lasts forever and never ends.
- C. is very large in size.
- D. cannot be moved at all.

Q3 L.5.6

voice

An author's **voice** is — /div>

- ◯ **A.** the loudness of a reader's speaking tone.
- ◯ **B.** the plain facts a story reports, with no personality.
- ◯ **C.** a copy of another writer's exact words.
- ◯ **D.** that writer's own style of expression.

Q4 L.5.6

monologue

A **monologue** is — /div>

- **A.** a quick back-and-forth conversation between two people.
- **B.** a long, uninterrupted speech.
- **C.** a short reply spoken by one person.
- **D.** several voices talking over one another.

Q5 L.5.4

yearning

If you are **yearning** for something, you — /div>

- ◯ **A.** want it very much and feel sad not to have it.
- ◯ **B.** already own more than enough of it.
- ◯ **C.** are giving it away to a friend.
- ◯ **D.** have forgotten all about it.

Q6 L.5.4

civil

A **civil** war is one that — /div>

- ◯ **A.** takes place far out at sea.
- ◯ **B.** happens between two different planets.
- ◯ **C.** happens among groups of people living within one country.
- ◯ **D.** is fought only with words, never weapons.

Q7 L.5.5 TRAP

flourishing

If something is **flourishing**, it is — /div>

- A. shrinking and dying out.
- B. growing and successful.
- C. empty and abandoned.
- D. frozen and still.

Q8 L.5.5 TRAP

fortunate

Someone who is **fortunate** is — /div>

- ◯ **A.** unlucky and full of bad luck.
- ◯ **B.** angry and unkind.
- ◯ **C.** tired and sleepy.
- ◯ **D.** lucky.

Q9 L.5.4

dedicate

When writers **dedicate** their work to someone, they — /div>

- ◯ **A.** sell it to that person for money.
- ◯ **B.** hide it so no one can read it.
- ◯ **C.** ask that person to finish writing it.
- ◯ **D.** offer it to that person to show admiration or affection.

Q10 L.5.4

relatives

Your **relatives** are — /div>

- ◯ **A.** the strangers you meet on a trip.
- ◯ **B.** the members of your family.
- ◯ **C.** the teachers at your school.
- ◯ **D.** the books you keep on a shelf.

Q11 L.5.5 TRAP

discarded

A **discarded** object is one that has been — /div>

- ◯ **A.** thrown away.
- ◯ **B.** carefully saved and treasured.
- ◯ **C.** newly bought from a store.
- ◯ **D.** wrapped up as a gift.

Q12 L.5.4

reluctantly

If you do something **reluctantly**, you do it — /div>

- ◯ **A.** as fast as you possibly can.
- ◯ **B.** with great excitement and joy.
- ◯ **C.** without really wanting to.
- ◯ **D.** over and over again for fun.

Q13 L.5.4

reserve

Reserve is — /div>

- **A.** a loud, boastful way of behaving.
- **B.** a quiet, sometimes shy, way of behaving.
- **C.** a rude, pushy way of behaving.
- **D.** a cheerful, talkative way of behaving.

Q14 L.5.5 TRAP

casual

Casual clothing is — /div>

- ◯ **A.** fancy and worn only on special days.
- ◯ **B.** made of heavy metal armor.
- ◯ **C.** too small to wear.
- ◯ **D.** not dressy and meant for everyday use.

Q15 L.5.4

nudged

If you **nudged** something, you — /div>

- ◯ **A.** threw it across the room.
- ◯ **B.** lifted it high over your head.
- ◯ **C.** gave it a little push.
- ◯ **D.** hid it under a blanket.

Q16 L.5.4

diary

A **diary** is — /div>

- ◯ **A.** a daily record of someone's experiences and feelings.
- ◯ **B.** a printed schedule of school assignments.
- ◯ **C.** a list of words and their meanings.
- ◯ **D.** a letter sent to a faraway friend.

Q17 L.5.4

promptly

When you do something **promptly**, you do it — /div>

- ◯ **A.** right away.
- ◯ **B.** many days later.
- ◯ **C.** only if someone reminds you.
- ◯ **D.** very slowly and carefully.

Q18 L.5.4

semidarkness

A place that is in **semidarkness** is — /div>

- **A.** filled with bright sunlight.
- **B.** lit up as brightly as midday.
- **C.** pitch-black, with no light at all.
- **D.** partially dark.

Q19 L.5.5 TRAP

obvious

Something that is **obvious** is — /div>

- **A.** hidden and hard to find.
- **B.** easy to see or understand.
- **C.** wet and cold to the touch.
- **D.** written in another language.

Q20 L.5.4

comprehended

If you **comprehended** something, you — /div>

- **A.** forgot it completely.
- **B.** copied it onto paper.
- **C.** understood it.
- **D.** threw it away.

Q21 L.5.4

officially

If something is done **officially**, it is — /div>

- **A.** kept secret from everyone.
- **B.** done only as a joke.
- **C.** approved by the government or someone in charge.
- **D.** finished without anyone noticing.

Q22 L.5.4

preliminary

Something that is **preliminary** happens — /div>

- ◯ **A.** at the very beginning of an event, or just before a main event.
- ◯ **B.** long after everything is over.
- ◯ **C.** in the very middle of an event.
- ◯ **D.** only by accident.

Q23 L.5.4

sponsor

A **sponsor** is someone who — /div>

- **A.** writes a daily record of feelings.
- **B.** helps an immigrant settle into his or her new country.
- **C.** leaves a country to live somewhere else.
- **D.** teaches a class how to cook.

Q24 L.5.4

generosity

When people show **generosity**, they — /div>

- **A.** take things away from others.
- **B.** stay silent and keep to themselves.
- **C.** refuse to share anything.
- **D.** give something valuable or meaningful to someone.

Q25 L.5.4

goodwill

When people show **goodwill**, they show — /div>

- **A.** anger toward strangers.
- **B.** a wish to be left completely alone.
- **C.** a fear of meeting new people.
- **D.** kindness toward others and a willingness to help.

Q26 L.5.4

grateful

When people are **grateful**, they are — /div>

- **A.** upset that they do not have more.
- **B.** bored with everything around them.
- **C.** happy and satisfied with what they have.
- **D.** afraid of what comes next.

Q27 L.5.4

exception

If something is an **exception**, it is — /div>

- **A.** left out of a group or list because it does not fit well.
- **B.** the most common thing in a group.
- **C.** the rule that everything follows.
- **D.** placed first on every list.

Q28 L.5.5 TRAP

sensible

A **sensible** rule is one that is — /div>

- **A.** confusing and hard to follow.
- **B.** simple and shows good judgment.
- **C.** silly and full of mistakes.
- **D.** unfair to everyone.

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · A Movie in My Pillow

POETRY · JORGE ARGUETA (ILLUS. ELIZABETH GÓMEZ) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.5.2

What are the poems in "A Movie in My Pillow" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A Vietnamese girl learning English in Alabama.
- ◯ **B.** An Indian girl baking a dessert with her mother in Texas.
- ◯ **C.** The speaker's life and feelings as he moves from El Salvador to the United States.
- ◯ **D.** A girl from Puerto Rico who keeps a diary.

Q2 RL.5.1

According to the Introduction, why did the speaker's family leave El Salvador?

- ◯ **A.** A bloody civil war made it dangerous to stay.
- ◯ **B.** They wanted to visit a new amusement park.
- ◯ **C.** Their house was too large for them.
- ◯ **D.** They were following a flock of parakeets.

Q3 RL.5.3

In the poem "Soup of Stars," what does the speaker compare the stars to, and why?

- ◯ **A.** To toys, because he liked to play.
- ◯ **B.** To books, because he loved to read.
- ◯ **C.** To birds, because they flew away.
- ◯ **D.** To soup, because on many nights the family went to bed without eating.

Q4 RL.5.3

How does the speaker feel about his Papa's orange truck in "My Papa's Orange Truck"?

- ◯ **A.** He is afraid of its loud noise.
- ◯ **B.** He is joyful and excited, running to help his father.
- ◯ **C.** He is bored and wishes he could stay home.
- ◯ **D.** He is angry that the truck is old.

Q5 RL.5.3

According to "Language of the Birds," which languages can the speaker use?

- ◯ **A.** Only English.
- ◯ **B.** Spanish, English, and Nahuatl.
- ◯ **C.** Only Spanish.
- ◯ **D.** French and English.

Q6 RL.5.5

How is "A Movie in My Pillow" structured as a text?

- ◯ **A.** As one long letter written to a friend.
- ◯ **B.** As a set of cooking directions.
- ◯ **C.** As a list of facts about Salvadoran cities.
- ◯ **D.** As a collection of poems organized into stanzas, including a concrete (shape) poem and free verse.

Q7 RL.5.6

From whose point of view are these poems told?

- ◯ **A.** The speaker himself, a Salvadoran boy, using first-person words like *I* and *my*.
- ◯ **B.** A teacher watching from outside the story.
- ◯ **C.** The grandmother who stayed in El Salvador.
- ◯ **D.** A narrator who never appears in the poems.

Q8 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "A Movie in My Pillow"?

- ◯ **A.** Once a family leaves home, they can never feel happy again.
- ◯ **B.** The best way to handle a move is to forget the old country completely.
- ◯ **C.** Moving to a new country is hard because of those left behind, but it can also bring new opportunities.
- ◯ **D.** City life is always better than life in the countryside.

Selection 2 · From Scratch

REALISTIC FICTION · SUSIE CASTELLANO (ILLUS. YELENA BRYKSENKOVA) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.5.2

What is "From Scratch" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A boy whose family sends him cassette tapes.
- ◯ **B.** A girl from Puerto Rico who is afraid to speak English at her new school.
- ◯ **C.** A poet remembering his grandmother's stories.
- ◯ **D.** Priya, a girl from India, who misses home while adjusting to a new life in Texas.

Q10 RL.5.3

According to the text, why does Priya feel reluctant to use the prepackaged baking mix?

- ◯ **A.** She has never baked anything before.
- ◯ **B.** In India, everything was made from scratch, and she misses the traditional way.
- ◯ **C.** The mix costs too much money.
- ◯ **D.** She is allergic to milk.

Q11 RL.5.3

According to the text, why does Priya hide her food in the school lunchroom?

- ◯ **A.** She is embarrassed because she has different food from the other children.
- ◯ **B.** She is saving it to eat later at home.
- ◯ **C.** She does not like the taste of any food.
- ◯ **D.** She wants to share it with a teacher.

Q12 RL.5.1

According to the text, what does Mummy tell Priya about Lindsay?

- ◯ **A.** Lindsay is moving away from Texas soon.
- ◯ **B.** Lindsay does not like Indian food.
- ◯ **C.** Lindsay grew up in Iran, was raised bilingual, and also had a hard time adjusting.
- ◯ **D.** Lindsay is Priya's cousin from Delhi.

Q13 RL.5.3

According to the text, what does Priya decide to do at the end of the story?

- ◯ **A.** Take the gulabjamun to school to share with her class.
- ◯ **B.** Stop speaking to her mother.
- ◯ **C.** Throw away her bangles.
- ◯ **D.** Move back to India right away.

Q14 RL.5.6

How does seeing the story through Priya's thoughts and feelings help the reader?

- ◯ **A.** It explains how to bake a dessert step by step.
- ◯ **B.** It lists the price of food at the supermarket.
- ◯ **C.** It lets the reader understand why she feels homesick and how her feelings change.
- ◯ **D.** It gives directions for getting to school.

Q15 RL.5.5

How is the conflict in "From Scratch" developed and then resolved?

- ◯ **A.** The story is told as a rhyming poem with no problem.
- ◯ **B.** The problem is solved on the very first page.
- ◯ **C.** There is no conflict at all in the story.
- ◯ **D.** Priya's problem of not fitting in builds as she feels homesick, then begins to resolve when she learns about Lindsay and offers to share Indian food.

Q16 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "From Scratch"?

- ◯ **A.** To fit in at a new school, you should hide everything that makes you different.
- ◯ **B.** Empathy, friendship, and sharing your own culture help a newcomer find belonging.
- ◯ **C.** Homemade food is always better than food bought at a store.
- ◯ **D.** A parent should change to match the people around them.

Selection 3 · Elisa's Diary

REALISTIC FICTION · DORIS LUISA ORONOZ (ILLUS. BYRON GIN) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.5.2

What is "Elisa's Diary" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A Vietnamese girl who learns one English word a day from a neighbor.
- ◯ **B.** A girl who moves from Puerto Rico to the United States and learns to feel at home.
- ◯ **C.** A boy baking sweets with his mother.
- ◯ **D.** A poet writing about parakeets and trucks.

Q18 RL.5.5

How does the author use a flashback near the beginning of the story?

- ◯ **A.** By describing the last day of Elisa's life as a teacher.
- ◯ **B.** By listing facts about squirrels in order.
- ◯ **C.** By skipping ahead to show Elisa as a grown woman first.
- ◯ **D.** By looking back to an earlier visit when Tata gave Elisa the porcelain squirrel.

Q19 RL.5.3

According to the text, why is Elisa afraid to go out at first?

- ◯ **A.** She is not confident about speaking English.
- ◯ **B.** She is afraid of the squirrels on the roof.
- ◯ **C.** She does not like the weather.
- ◯ **D.** She has too much homework to do.

Q20 RL.5.3

According to the text, what deal do Elisa and José make?

- ◯ **A.** They agree to trade lunches every day.
- ◯ **B.** They promise never to speak in class.
- ◯ **C.** She will help him with writing, and he will help her with pronunciation.
- ◯ **D.** They decide to draw pictures together.

Q21 RL.5.1

Which detail BEST shows that Elisa changes by the end of the story?

- ◯ **A.** She refuses to ever speak English.
- ◯ **B.** She moves back to Puerto Rico right away.
- ◯ **C.** She grows up to graduate from high school and become a teacher herself.
- ◯ **D.** She stops writing in her diary forever.

Q22 RL.5.6

Why does the author tell part of the story through Elisa's diary entries?

- ◯ **A.** To let the reader hear Elisa's private feelings in her own words.
- ◯ **B.** To explain how to care for a pet squirrel.
- ◯ **C.** To give the rules of the English language.
- ◯ **D.** To list the customs of Guatemala.

Q23 RL.5.2

What does "the joining of forces" mean in this story?

- ◯ **A.** Soldiers fighting in a war.
- ◯ **B.** Two squirrels gathering acorns.
- ◯ **C.** A teacher grading a stack of papers.
- ◯ **D.** People from different cultures helping one another to succeed.

Q24 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "Elisa's Diary"?

- ◯ **A.** The fastest way to learn a new language is to study it completely alone.
- ◯ **B.** Helping one another lets newcomers from different cultures grow confident and succeed.
- ◯ **C.** If a new place feels hard at first, it is best to go back home.
- ◯ **D.** A person who is good at speaking must also be good at writing.

Selection 4 · Inside Out and Back Again

POETRY · THANHHA LAI (ILLUS. LISA FIELDS) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.5.2

What is "Inside Out and Back Again" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** Hà, a Vietnamese girl who resettles in Alabama and adjusts to a new language and school.
- ◯ **B.** A girl baking gulabjamun in Texas.
- ◯ **C.** A boy riding a purple bicycle in El Salvador.
- ◯ **D.** A girl from Puerto Rico making friends with José.

Q26 RL.5.3

According to the text, who is Mrs. Washington, and how does she help Hà?

- ◯ **A.** Hà's mother, who works at a sewing factory.
- ◯ **B.** Hà's classmate, who shares her lunch.
- ◯ **C.** A kind, retired teacher next door who teaches Hà one new English word a day.
- ◯ **D.** The family's sponsor, whom Hà calls a cowboy.

Q27 RL.5.3

According to the "Rule" poems, how does Hà feel about learning English grammar?

- ◯ **A.** She thinks the rules are simple and easy.
- ◯ **B.** She is frustrated, because the rules seem full of exceptions and do not always make sense.
- ◯ **C.** She does not care about English at all.
- ◯ **D.** She already knows every rule perfectly.

Q28 RL.5.3

According to "Most Relieved Day," why is Hà surprised by her classmates?

- ◯ **A.** They give her a new bicycle.
- ◯ **B.** They ask her to teach them Vietnamese.
- ◯ **C.** They bring her food from Vietnam.
- ◯ **D.** They smile at her instead of laughing at her.

Q29 RL.5.5

How is "Inside Out and Back Again" structured as a text?

- ◯ **A.** As one long paragraph with no breaks.
- ◯ **B.** As a list of recipes from Vietnam.
- ◯ **C.** As a play with actors speaking on a stage.
- ◯ **D.** As a series of dated free-verse poems organized into stanzas that together tell Hà's story.

Q30 RL.5.6

Why does the poet write the poems from Hà's first-person point of view?

- ◯ **A.** To explain how a washing machine works.
- ◯ **B.** To let the reader feel Hà's own loneliness, frustration, and hope as she adapts.
- ◯ **C.** To give the exact distance from Vietnam to Alabama.
- ◯ **D.** To list the rules of English grammar in order.

Q31 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "Inside Out and Back Again"?

- ◯ **A.** A new language should be given up if its rules seem unfair.
- ◯ **B.** A family is happy in a new home as soon as the house is comfortable.
- ◯ **C.** Moving to a new country and learning a new language is lonely and hard, but kindness and persistence make things better.
- ◯ **D.** Newcomers are bound to be laughed at by their classmates.

Q32 RL.5.3

According to the text, how do Hà's feelings change from the start of the selection to the end?

- ◯ **A.** She begins lonely and frustrated but starts to adjust, makes friends, and feels more hopeful.
- ◯ **B.** She begins happy and grows angrier and angrier.
- ◯ **C.** She feels exactly the same the whole time.
- ◯ **D.** She decides to return to Vietnam at the end.

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how people adapt to a new home. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Change DOK 3

In **"A Movie in My Pillow,"** the speaker moves from El Salvador to San Francisco. Show what he LEFT BEHIND and what he FOUND in his new home, then explain how he changes.

WHAT CHANGED · THE SPEAKER

WHAT HE LEFT BEHIND	WHAT HE FOUND IN HIS NEW HOME

How does the speaker change from the beginning of the poems to the end? Use the word *change* in your answer.

Q2 Connection DOK 3

In **"From Scratch,"** Priya and Lindsay both feel like outsiders. Show the PROBLEM and the TURNING POINT, then explain how empathy helps Priya begin to belong.

PROBLEM AND TURNING POINT · PRIYA

PRIYA'S PROBLEM	→	THE TURNING POINT

How does understanding Lindsay help Priya begin to feel she belongs? Use one detail from the text.

Q3 Perseverance DOK 3

In **"Elisa's Diary,"** Elisa struggles with English but does not give up. Show the STEPS of her journey, then explain how "the joining of forces" helps her succeed.

HOW ELISA SUCCEEDS

THE STRUGGLE	THE HELP	THE RESULT
how does Elisa feel at first?	*how do Elisa and José help each other?*	*what does Elisa become?*

How does "the joining of forces" help Elisa succeed? Use one detail from the selection.

Q4 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Inside Out and Back Again,"** Hà faces a hard new life, and others choose to help her. Show a CHALLENGE Hà faces and the KINDNESS she receives, then explain why goodwill matters.

CHALLENGE AND KINDNESS · HÀ

A CHALLENGE HÀ FACES	KINDNESS SHE RECEIVES

Why does the goodwill of others matter for a newcomer like Hà? Explain using one detail.

Q5 Inquiry DOK 4

Essential Question: How do people adapt to new experiences and make a new place home? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

How did this character adapt to a new home?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

How did this character adapt to a new home?

MY BIG IDEA

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The New Girl at Lunch

On her first day at the new school, Mei carried her lunch tray to a corner and sat alone. Everything felt strange. The voices around her were loud and fast, and she could not follow the jokes that made the other children laugh. She opened her lunch box and looked at the rice and vegetables her mother had packed. A few kids glanced over, and Mei felt her cheeks grow warm. She wished she could disappear. Then a girl with a long braid slid into the seat across from her. "Hi, I'm Priya," the girl said with a smile. "I was the new kid last year. It gets easier, I promise." Mei did not understand every word, but she understood the kind smile. Priya pointed to Mei's lunch. "That looks really good. Way better than mine." Mei laughed for the first time all day. The two girls traded a little food and tried to talk, half in English and half with their hands. By the end of lunch, Mei did not feel quite so alone. She still missed her old home, but now there was one friendly face waiting for her tomorrow.

192 WORDS · LEXILE 620— 00L · RIT 205— 11

Q1 RIT 205 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

Where does Mei sit at the start of the passage?

- ◯ **A.** Next to her best friend.
- ◯ **B.** At a table full of laughing kids.
- ◯ **C.** Alone in a corner.
- ◯ **D.** Outside on the playground.

Q2 RIT 207 · Lexile 640L · Cause & Effect

Why does Mei's face grow warm?

- ◯ **A.** A few kids glance at her lunch and she feels embarrassed.
- ◯ **B.** The lunchroom is too hot.
- ◯ **C.** She is sitting near a window in the sun.
- ◯ **D.** She just finished running outside.

Q3 RIT 208 · Lexile 660L · Key Detail

What does Priya tell Mei?

- ◯ **A.** That she should sit somewhere else.
- ◯ **B.** That the food is not allowed at school.
- ◯ **C.** That she cannot understand her.
- ◯ **D.** That she was the new kid last year and it gets easier.

Q4 RIT 210 · Lexile 685L · Inference

How does Mei most likely feel at the END of the passage?

- ◯ **A.** Angry at Priya for bothering her.
- ◯ **B.** A little less alone and more hopeful.
- ◯ **C.** Eager to move to another school.
- ◯ **D.** Exactly as lonely as before.

Q5 RIT 211 · Lexile 700L · Theme

What is the main message, or theme, of this passage?

- ◯ **A.** A newcomer should wait quietly alone until others come to greet them first.
- ◯ **B.** A small act of kindness can help a newcomer feel welcome.
- ◯ **C.** A new school always stays a scary place no matter who you meet.
- ◯ **D.** Trading food is the only way to make a friend at a new school.

Passage 2 · How New Languages Are Learned

Moving to a country where people speak a different language can feel overwhelming at first. The good news is that scientists have studied how people learn new languages, and they have found a few things that help. The first is practice. Learning a language is not something that happens by reading once. Experts say the brain learns words best when a person hears them and uses them again and again in real conversations. The second helper is living among speakers of the language. When someone is surrounded by a language all day, they pick it up far faster than from a book alone. A third helper is making mistakes without fear. New speakers who are willing to try, even when they say something wrong, learn more quickly than those who stay silent. Friendly listeners make a big difference, too. A patient friend or neighbor who answers questions can turn a scary task into a daily habit. Over time, single words grow into sentences, and sentences grow into real talk. Learning a new language takes patience, but step by step, a newcomer gains the confidence to make friends, ask for help, and feel at home.

194 WORDS · LEXILE 740— 40L · RIT 211— 17

Q6 RIT 211 · Lexile 740L · Key Detail

According to the passage, what is the FIRST thing that helps people learn a new language?

- ◯ **A.** Reading a book one time.
- ◯ **B.** Staying completely silent.
- ◯ **C.** Moving to a quiet place alone.
- ◯ **D.** Practice — hearing and using words again and again.

Q7 RIT 213 · Lexile 770L · Key Detail

According to the passage, why does living among speakers help?

- ◯ **A.** It means a person never has to study.
- ◯ **B.** It makes books unnecessary forever.
- ◯ **C.** Being surrounded by a language all day helps a person pick it up faster.
- ◯ **D.** It lets a person avoid speaking at all.

Q8 RIT 214 · Lexile 800L · Vocabulary

In the passage, the word **overwhelming** means that the experience can feel —
/div>

- ◯ **A.** easy and relaxing.
- ◯ **B.** like too much to handle at first.
- ◯ **C.** funny and exciting.
- ◯ **D.** boring and slow.

Q9 RIT 215 · Lexile 820L · Author's Purpose

Why does the author mention "making mistakes without fear"?

- ◯ **A.** To show that willing learners who try, even imperfectly, learn faster.
- ◯ **B.** To warn readers never to speak.
- ◯ **C.** To explain how to write a book.
- ◯ **D.** To list the names of languages.

Q10 RIT 217 · Lexile 840L · Main Idea

What is the main idea of "How New Languages Are Learned"?

- ◯ **A.** With practice, real conversation, and patience, a newcomer can learn a new language and feel at home.
- ◯ **B.** The only sure way to learn a new language is to study quietly from a book by yourself.
- ◯ **C.** Because the brain is set early in life, a person who moves abroad can never truly learn the language.
- ◯ **D.** To learn a language well, a speaker should stay silent until they can say everything perfectly.

Passage 3 · Diego's Two Kitchens

When Diego moved from Mexico to Chicago, the hardest part was missing his grandmother's kitchen. Back home, the air had always smelled of warm tortillas and simmering beans. In the new apartment, the kitchen felt empty and quiet. Diego barely wanted to eat. One Saturday, his mother handed him an apron. "We are going to cook," she said. "Not to forget home, but to bring it here." Together they rolled out

dough and pressed it flat, just as Abuela had taught them. Soon the whole apartment smelled like Mexico again. The next week, Diego invited a boy from his class named Sam. Diego was nervous. What if Sam thought the food was strange? But Sam took one bite of a fresh tortilla and grinned. "This is amazing," he said. "Can you teach me?" So they cooked together, and Diego explained each step in careful English. Sam shared snacks from his own family, too. Bit by bit, the quiet kitchen filled with two languages, two kinds of food, and the laughter of a new friend. Diego still missed Abuela, but now his new home had a kitchen that felt warm again.

190 WORDS · LEXILE 760— 60L · RIT 217— 22

Q11 RIT 217 Lexile 760L Key Detail

According to the passage, what was the hardest part of Diego's move?

- ◯ **A.** Finding a new school.
- ◯ **B.** Learning to ride the train.
- ◯ **C.** Buying a winter coat.
- ◯ **D.** Missing his grandmother's kitchen.

Q12 RIT 218 Lexile 790L Cause & Effect

What happens after Diego and his mother cook together?

- ◯ **A.** The whole apartment smells like Mexico again.
- ◯ **B.** They decide to move back to Mexico.
- ◯ **C.** Diego stops eating altogether.
- ◯ **D.** The kitchen stays empty and quiet.

Q13 RIT 219 Lexile 820L Character

How does Diego feel when he first invites Sam over?

- ◯ **A.** Certain that Sam will dislike him.
- ◯ **B.** Bored and uninterested.
- ◯ **C.** Nervous that Sam might think the food is strange.
- ◯ **D.** Angry at his mother.

Q14 RIT 220 Lexile 840L Inference

What does the mother mean by "Not to forget home, but to bring it here"?

- ◯ **A.** They should never cook Mexican food again.
- ◯ **B.** They can keep their old traditions alive in their new home.
- ◯ **C.** They must throw away the apron.
- ◯ **D.** They should forget Mexico completely.

Q15 RIT 222 · Lexile 860L · Theme

What is the main message, or theme, of this passage?

- ◯ **A.** The best way to settle into a new country is to give up the foods of the old one.
- ◯ **B.** A new home can never feel as warm as the home a family left behind.
- ◯ **C.** Making new friends means keeping your own traditions to yourself.
- ◯ **D.** Sharing your culture can turn a new place into a real home and build new friendships.

Passage 4 · Why People Move to New Places

Throughout history, people have moved from one place to another. The reasons are many, but a few come up again and again. One common reason is safety. When war, danger, or disaster strikes a region, families may leave to protect themselves, even if it means starting over far from home. A second reason is opportunity. Some people move to find work, to join family members already settled, or to give their children a better education. A third reason is change itself. A new job, a new school, or simply the wish to try a different life can lead a family to pack up and go. Moving is rarely easy. Newcomers often miss the food, the language, and the friends they left behind, and learning the customs of a new place takes time. Yet people are remarkably good at adapting. They keep parts of their old culture, such as their holidays and recipes, while slowly learning new ways. They make friends, find favorite places, and build new routines. In this way, a strange place gradually becomes familiar. Although the journey can be hard, history shows that people can carry their past with them while making a brand-new place their home.

199 WORDS · LEXILE 860— 60L · RIT 219— 25

Q16 RIT 219 · Lexile 860L · Key Detail

According to the passage, what is one common reason people move?

- ◯ **A.** To collect more furniture.
- ◯ **B.** To avoid making any friends.
- ◯ **C.** To forget their old culture.
- ◯ **D.** Safety — to protect themselves from war, danger, or disaster.

Q17 RIT 220 · Lexile 890L · Key Detail

According to the passage, what is one part of "opportunity" as a reason to move?

- ◯ **A.** Finding worse weather.
- ◯ **B.** Leaving all family behind on purpose.
- ◯ **C.** Finding work, joining family, or giving children a better education.
- ◯ **D.** Avoiding all schools.

Q18 RIT 221 | Lexile 910L | Cause & Effect

According to the passage, why is moving "rarely easy"?

- ◯ **A.** Because new places have no food at all.
- ◯ **B.** Because no one ever adapts.
- ◯ **C.** Because newcomers often miss the food, language, and friends they left behind, and learning new customs takes time.
- ◯ **D.** Because moving is against the law.

Q19 RIT 223 | Lexile 935L | Author's Purpose

Why does the author explain that people "keep parts of their old culture" while learning new ways?

- ◯ **A.** To prove that moving should never be done.
- ◯ **B.** To show how newcomers adapt by blending the old and the new.
- ◯ **C.** To explain how to cook a holiday meal.
- ◯ **D.** To list every country in the world.

Q20 RIT 225 | Lexile 960L | Main Idea

What is the main idea of "Why People Move to New Places"?

- ◯ **A.** People move for many reasons, and though it is hard, they can carry their past while making a new place home.
- ◯ **B.** People move for only one reason, and that reason is always to find safety from war.
- ◯ **C.** Moving is usually quick and simple, so newcomers rarely miss anything from before.
- ◯ **D.** To make a new place home, people must leave every part of their old culture behind.